

# Motorola Moto G54 5G

Monstrous battery but underwhelming display quality

I got the Moto G54 5G for review recently and it is a departure from some of the latest Moto phones when it comes to design – the focus isn't as much on being slim and lightweight as it is on having improved longevity in terms of battery life. It succeeds the Moto G52 since the G53 didn't make it to India. So, is it a good upgrade and a value proposition at this price? Let's find out!

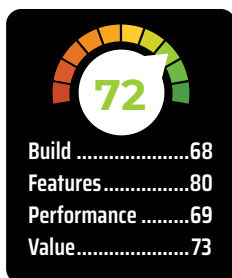
## BUILD AND DESIGN

I won't lie; when I first set my eyes on the Moto G54 5G, I was slightly discontented. I knew, in the back of my mind, that adding a 6,000 mAh cell would mean some compromises in the build and design, but the Moto G54 is so much thicker than the current slew of Motorola phones, that it stands out – and not in a good way, in my opinion. The phone is visibly thick at 8.9 mm – thicker than the G52 which sat at 8 mm and much bulkier than its cousin – the Moto G84 at 7.6 mm. The phone is still relatively lightweight at 192 g, but the difference in design language is noticeable.

The phone's rear panel is made of PMMA plastic that looks deceptively like matte glass. It resists fingerprints but does collect a few smudges along the way. The Motorola branding is nice and subtle, the camera module is compact and the camera lenses don't jut out a lot. All good things. The buttons on the right feel a bit mushy though, the tactility could be improved. The side-mounted fingerprint on the power button is great though; very fast and accurate.

The phone comes packing dual stereo speakers with Dolby Atmos sup-

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port. They sound full-bodied and loud, so content consumption in terms of sound is good. As for the front, the chin bezel is quite thick and so is the top one, so it feels less premium because of that. You've got IP52 dust and splash resistance, which is decent for the price. Overall, the phone has a decent build. The lack of sleekness we've come to expect from Motorola phones is apparent, but it could be a justified trade-off for the bigger battery for many users.

## DISPLAY

The Moto G54's display disappointed me. Unlike the design, where the tradeoffs bring a huge improvement in battery life, I think the display on the Moto G54 has just regressed. The Moto G52 provided an AMOLED display, which looked superb, but Moto has gone with a plain ol' IPS LCD display on the

G54. You get a 6.5-inch IPS LCD display with Full HD+ resolution and 120 Hz refresh rate. The display's detail is good but it lacks vibrancy, which can sour the content consumption experience.

I would have still forgiven the IPS LCD display if that was it since many phones at this budget don't come with AMOLED panels. However, the display's brightness is also problematic; especially during sunny days. I measured a peak brightness of just 282 nits in sunlight on Auto Mode, which is very low. Naturally, I faced some difficulty reading the screen in broad daylight, which is very problematic. The viewing angles of the display are also sub-par.

## PERFORMANCE

The Motorola G54 5G is the first smartphone in India to house the new MediaTek Dimensity 7020 SoC. It is an octa-core processor with a max clock speed of 2.2 GHz and is quite speedy for its price. It is fantastic that Motorola has chosen this SoC at this price because it nearly matches up to the performance of the more expensive Moto G84 which comes with the Snapdragon 695 SoC. You've also got 8/12 GB of LPDDR4X RAM and 128/256 GB of UFS 2.2 storage, and in our storage benchmarks, the Motorola G54 performed brilliantly, beating out many competitors like the Realme 11x and Samsung Galaxy M14.

Starting off with CPU benchmarks, the Motorola G54 shows off its prowess. I compared it against similarly-priced offerings such as the iQOO Z7, Samsung Galaxy M14, and Realme 11x. In AnTuTu, the Moto G54 got a score of 460,000+ which effectively beat out the Galaxy M14 and Realme 11x but lagged a bit behind the iQOO Z7.

In GeekBench, the Moto G54 had decent Single-Core performance but it is in the Multi-Core test that it showed off its power with an excellent score of 2291 – the highest of the lot. In PCMark Work, the Moto G54 destroyed its competition, which means it will excel at productivity tasks. In GPU benchmarks, the Moto G54 performed